AzureSky Pty Ltd
Proficiency Testing Scheme – Participant Instructions
AzureSky PT Scheme- Round 13
Date: 17 November 2025

"Sample B"

Dear Participants, below are the instructions to participate in the AzureSky (Pty) Ltd Proficiency Testing scheme.

1. Objective of the Study

The purpose of this proficiency testing (PT) round is to evaluate the performance and analytical capability of participating laboratories in determining the analysis as outlined in the ***link*** provided via email.

2. Confidentiality and Independence

Participants are strictly prohibited from exchanging results or comparing data with other laboratories during the study. This measure ensures the integrity and independence of the performance evaluation. Collusion or collaborative data sharing undermines the objectives of ISO 33405.

3. Replicate Determinations

Participants are required to perform 2 replicate determination(s) per unit, using their routine analytical methods.

4. Method Instructions

- Put a zero (0) for all parameters which you have not participated in this round, **this is crucial as you will not be able to submit the form with blank spaces.**

- All results submitted should be on an air-dry basis.

- Samples shall be conditioned for at least 3 hours prior to analysis.

- All volatile results should be corrected for inherent moisture.
For example, Volatile as analysed= 23.6% and Inherent moisture= 2.8%. Corrected volatile = Volatile as analysed – Inherent moisture = 23.6-2.8=20.8%.

- Only use a reducing atmosphere for Ash Fusion Temperature analysis

- Submit calorific value analysis results as they appear on the instrument, do not convert or correct for sulphur.
- All results submitted for hydrogen analysis must be corrected for inherent moisture, use below formula: Corrected Hydrogen = Hydrogen (obtained from instrument) – inherent moisture x 0.1119.

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5. Measurement Quality and Traceability

- Measurements must be traceable to recognized national/international standards.

- Apply internal quality assurance (QA) and quality control (QC) procedures.

- Ensure accuracy and identify bias through appropriate measures.

6. Time Schedule

Distribution of samples : No later than 10th of every month

Submission of results : No later than 25th of every month

Feedback report to participants : No later than 06th of every month

7. Mode of Dispatch

Samples will be dispatched via courier or hand delivered by Azuresky Pty Ltd, securely packaged and labelled.

8. Sample Storage Requirements

Upon receipt, store samples as following:

- Temperature: Room temperature should not be greater than 23°C.

- Conditions: Keep sealed, dry, and away from heat or contamination.

9. Sample Treatment Instructions

Where applicable, follow specific instructions for sample pre-treatment. If none are provided, proceed with routine preparation methods.

10. Internal Quality Control Measures

Participants should implement QC measures such as:

- Use of internal reference materials

- Control charts

- Duplicate analysis

- Spike recovery (where relevant)

NB: Any anomalies or suspected bias should be documented and submitted with your results.

11. Laboratory Identification and Data Use Policy

- Each lab will be assigned a unique confidential code.

- Results will be anonymized in reporting unless explicit permission is granted.

- Data may be used for further characterization or interlaboratory comparison.

12. Standards

- Ash Content (ISO 1171)

- Volatile Matter (ISO 562)

- Gross Calorific Value (ISO 1928)

- Total Sulphur (ASTM D42390)

- Total Moisture (ISO 589)

- Inherent Moisture (SANS 2925-2007)

- Ash Fusion Temperature (SANS 43:2008) **Reducing atmosphere only**

- Particle Size Distribution (ISO 1953)

13. Contact Information

Proficiency Testing Coordinator: **Sifiso B Nyambi**

Email: sifiso@azuresky.it.com

Phone: 082 786 8149

Website: https://azuresky.it.com/

14. Participant Confirmation

Kindly confirm receipt of the PT materials and intent to participate within 1 week of receiving the PT sample(s) using the provided emails.

Thank you for your participation and your continued commitment to quality improvement.



Nonhlanhla Msibi: Managing Director/ Proficiency Testing Scheme Manager

Email: nonhlanhla@azuresky.it.com

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